

New York Asian Design Week 2026 Open Call

Traces of Force

New York Asian Design Week 2026 is now accepting submissions for **Traces of Force**, the inaugural Physical edition of NYADW.

We invite designers, artists, architects, makers, and creative practitioners to submit work that explores how force, material, body, environment, memory, and culture shape physical design today.

Selected works will be exhibited at **Gallery 456** from **August 5, 2026**, through **August 21, 2026**, as the main venue of **New York Asian Design Week 2026**.

Submission Deadline: July 24, 2026

Application Email: support@nyadw.org

Email Subject: 2026, Artist Name

Curatorial Statement

Traces of Force

Force Forms Matter

Force forms matter. It bends, compresses, erodes, and resists. Before design becomes an object, image, or space, it passes through conditions that shape it: gravity, pressure, movement, material behavior, bodily habit, environmental change, and cultural memory. Some forces can be measured. Others can only be sensed. But once they meet matter, they leave a trace.

Traces of Force considers physical design as the record of these encounters. A form is not a finished appearance — it is the consequence of contact. Between idea and material. Body and environment. Memory and transformation. The exhibition asks viewers to move past surface and style and instead attend to the operations behind form: what pushes, what yields, and what remains.

As the Physical edition of New York Asian Design Week's two-year dialogue between **Physical** and **Digital**, this exhibition turns toward what design becomes when it leaves the screen. The digital allows form to move with speed, fluidity, and simulation. The physical introduces resistance. It has weight, grain, temperature, and duration. It must be inhabited. The physical does not oppose the digital — it makes different demands of the body.

Those demands, in New York, are also cultural. Asian design is often asked to be visible but easily readable — culturally marked, yet globally fluent. **Traces of Force** refuses that position. It treats Asian design not as a fixed aesthetic, but as a practice under pressure: between restraint and expression, place and displacement, continuity and the force to change. Identity here is not held in motif. It is formed through material decision, adaptation, and what gets carried forward.

A trace is partial and open. It is what remains after contact — not the force itself, but its consequence. Design, seen this way, is not the imposition of form onto matter. It is matter registering what has acted upon it.

Application Guidelines

Please email the following materials to **support@nyadw.org** with the subject line:

2026, Artist Name

Example: 2026, *Claude Monet*

Please include:

1. Applicant name / team name
 2. Project title
 3. Project description, 250–500 words
 4. 3–5 project images and/or video link, each file no larger than 15MB
 5. Medium, dimensions, and installation requirements
 6. Artist bio and CV / resume
 7. Optional — social media / website
 8. Any special equipment needs
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About New York Asian Design Week

New York Asian Design Week (NYADW) is an annual cultural platform celebrating the diverse voices shaping contemporary Asian design in New York City and beyond. Founded by **Lighthouse Global Foundation Inc.**, NYADW brings together architects, artists, designers, makers, and creative thinkers whose work reflects the evolving relationship between culture, identity, technology, and the built environment.

NYADW operates on a two-year curatorial cycle exploring two complementary themes: **Physical** and **Digital**. Each year focuses on one of these dimensions, creating an ongoing dialogue between tangible and virtual forms of design.